

CA Intermediate — Full-Time Study Plan (both groups, one attempt)

Assumptions: full-time, ~8 hrs/day, 6 days/week; self-study on ICAI BoS material; ~8-month runway aligning with the study-period rule. Target: clear **both groups together** on the first attempt.

The 6 papers

Grp	Paper	Nature	Your MBA edge?
1	P1 Advanced Accounting	Practical (problem-solving)	Partial
1	P2 Corporate & Other Laws	Theory / memory	No
1	P3 Taxation (Income Tax + GST)	Practical + provisions	Partial
2	P4 Cost & Management Accounting	Practical	Yes
2	P5 Auditing & Ethics	Theory / memory	No
2	P6 Financial Management + Strategic Management	FM practical, SM theory	Strong (FM)

Each paper = 100 marks, 3 hours, **30% MCQ + 70% subjective**, with **0.25 negative marking** on wrong MCQs. Don't guess blindly on MCQs.

Hour budget (per week, first-pass phase)

Weight harder/heavier papers more. Rough weekly split of ~48 hrs:

- Advanced Accounting — 10 hrs
 - Taxation (IT + GST) — 10 hrs
 - Corporate & Other Laws — 8 hrs
 - Cost & Management — 6 hrs
 - Audit & Ethics — 7 hrs
 - FM + SM — 5 hrs (lighter for you — leverage MBA background)
 - **+ daily:** 1 hr revision of *yesterday's* topics, 30 min MCQ practice
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Three phases over ~34 weeks

Phase 1 — First pass / concept building (Weeks 1–20)

Learn every chapter once, working problems as you go. Pair a **practical** paper with a **theory** paper each day so you don't burn out.

Suggested chapter order:

- **Accounting:** Company accounts → Financial statements → AS (Accounting Standards, chunk them) → Special transactions (branch, departmental, partnership, ESOP, buyback).
- **Taxation — Income Tax first (5 heads → deductions → TDS → returns), then GST** (supply → ITC → registration → returns). Keep a running "amendments" note for the applicable Finance Act.
- **Law:** Companies Act 2013 (bulk) → then Other Laws (GCA, FEMA basics, Interpretation).
- **Cost:** Costing methods → Marginal/standard costing → Budgeting → Cost sheets.
- **Audit:** Nature & basic concepts → SAs (Standards on Auditing) → Company audit → Ethics.
- **FM+SM:** FM (cost of capital, capital budgeting, working capital, leverage) — fast for you → SM (theory, do near exam).

Weekly rhythm (Phase 1):

- Mon–Sat: 2 papers/day (one practical + one theory), ~8 hrs
- End of each week: 2-hr self-quiz on the week's chapters + update your amendment/formula sheets
- Sunday: light — MCQs, backlog, rest

Phase 2 — Consolidation + module-wise revision (Weeks 21–29)

- Second read of all subjects, **faster** (you're revising, not learning).
- Solve **past exam papers + ICAI Suggested Answers**, chapter by chapter.
- Build one-page **summary/formula/section sheets** for every subject (these become your final-week revision).
- Start attempting **RTPs (Revision Test Papers)** for the applicable exam session.

Phase 3 — Mocks & final revision (Weeks 30–34)

- Attempt every **MTP (Mock Test Paper)** ICAI releases for your session, **full 3-hr timed, hand-written**, then self-evaluate against Suggested Answers.
- Target **2 full mocks/week**, rotating groups.
- Final loop: revise only from your summary sheets + weak-area log.
- Last 10 days: no new topics — pure revision, MCQ drills, and presentation practice.

Practice cadence (non-negotiables)

- **RTP** — do 100%, every subject, for your exam session (ICAI hints at what's important).
- **MTP** — attempt all series, timed.
- **Past papers** — last 5–6 attempts, with Suggested Answers.

- **MCQs** — daily; track accuracy; be careful (negative marking).
 - **Amendments** — Tax & Law change every session; always study the *edition applicable to your attempt*.
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Free resources (self-study)

- **ICAI BoS Study Material** (module-wise PDFs/books) — primary source, exam is set from this.
 - **ICAI BoS Knowledge Portal** — free recorded/live lectures per subject.
 - **RTP / MTP / Suggested Answers / Past Papers** — all free under Students → BoS / Examination on [icaai.org](https://www.icaai.org).
 - Keep a single **"weak areas" log** — every question you got wrong goes here; revise it weekly.
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Presentation tips (scoring, not just knowing)

- Practical papers: show **working notes**, correct format, and rounding.
- Law/Audit: quote **section numbers / SA numbers** where you can, then explain.
- Time discipline: ~1.8 min per mark. Attempt the full paper — partial answers still score.

Log your daily hours and chapter completions in `05_Tracker.md`.